CREATOR DUE DILIGENCE

Read the **comments** before you pay for the **views.**



How to turn a comment section into a booking decision.

THE STAKES

20.2%

of YouTube comments were rated **useful to the creator.**

70.1% nothing much either way

10.2% real questions

73.3% never get a like

Source: CommentShark YouTube Comment Report 2026. 9.88M comments, 15,403 channels. Vendor study, comments labelled by AI.

CHECK 01

Count the real questions.

“Does it work with our stack?” “What does it cost for a team?” Questions like these sound like someone thinking about buying.

Watch out: 42.6% of comments with a question mark aren’t asking anything.

Source: CommentShark YouTube Comment Report 2026 (vendor study, comments labelled by AI).

CHECK 02

Look for **buyer fingerprints.**

Job titles, team size, the tools they already run. “We use”, “my team”, “our repo”. That’s your buyer talking.

CHECK 03

Find the **“I tried it”** comments.

Open the creator’s last sponsored video. Did anyone say they installed, signed up or switched? That’s a sign the audience acts, in public.

CHECK 04

Does the **creator answer?**

A creator who replies to technical questions in the thread is building trust you get to borrow. Silence is a signal too.

CHECK 05

Watch for repeated text.

The same comment, word for word, on unrelated channels. In the 2026 study the median channel had 11% repeated text.

Repeated text doesn’t tell you who wrote it. It tells you to look closer.

Source: CommentShark YouTube Comment Report 2026 (vendor study, comments labelled by AI).

CHECK 06

Read the **sponsor's** comments.

Scroll to what viewers said about the last brand on the channel. Curious, neutral or annoyed? Your read lands in the same room.

THE TAKEAWAY

Credibility is **overtaking visibility.**

73% of B2B marketers agree brand credibility is becoming more important than brand visibility.

Source: LinkedIn research with Censuswide, Sep 2026. 6,196 B2B marketers.

Want creators whose comments **read like your buyers?**

Comment “MAP” →